

Jacobian Descent For Multi-Objective Optimization

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Joint work with Pierre Quinton

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github.com/TorchJD/torchjd



torchjd.org



arxiv.org/pdf/2406.16232

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Theory

Multi-objective optimization

Define the partial order $(\mathbb{R}^m, \preceq)$, for $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^m$, as

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{u} \preceq \mathbf{v} \\ \Leftrightarrow \quad u_i \leq v_i \quad \forall i \in [m] \end{aligned}$$

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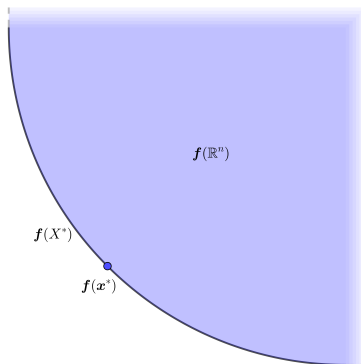
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$$\mathbf{x}^* \in X^* \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \forall \mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}^n, \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{y}) \preceq \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}^*) \rightarrow \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}^*)$$

Pareto optimality

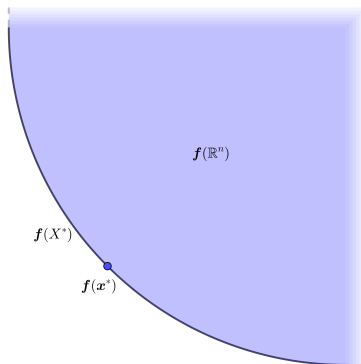
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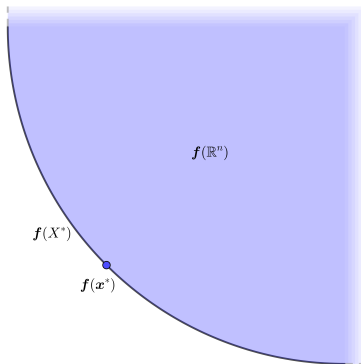


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Pareto Front: $\mathbf{f}(X^*)$



First-order Taylor approximation

For any $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, the Jacobian of $\mathbf{f}$ at $\mathbf{x}$, is

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For a small enough update $\mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, Taylor's theorem states

$$\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{y}) \approx \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}) + \mathcal{J}\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}) \cdot \mathbf{y}$$

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$$\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{y}) \approx \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}) + \mathcal{J}\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}) \cdot \mathbf{y}$$

We select $\mathbf{y} = -\eta \mathcal{A}(\mathcal{J}\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x})) \in \mathbb{R}^n$.

Jacobian descent

The mapping $\mathcal{A} : \mathbb{R}^{m \times n} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$ is called an **aggregator**, it parameterizes **Jacobian descent**:

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Algorithm 1: Jacobian descent with aggregator $\mathcal{A}$

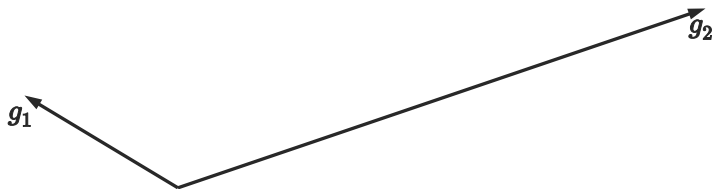
Input: $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, $0 < \eta$, $T \in \mathbb{N}$, $\mathcal{A} : \mathbb{R}^{m \times n} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$

for $t \leftarrow 1$ **to** T **do**

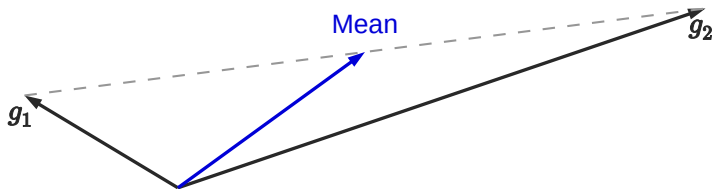
$\mathbf{x} \leftarrow \mathbf{x} - \eta \mathcal{A}(\mathcal{J}\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}))$

Output: $\mathbf{x}$

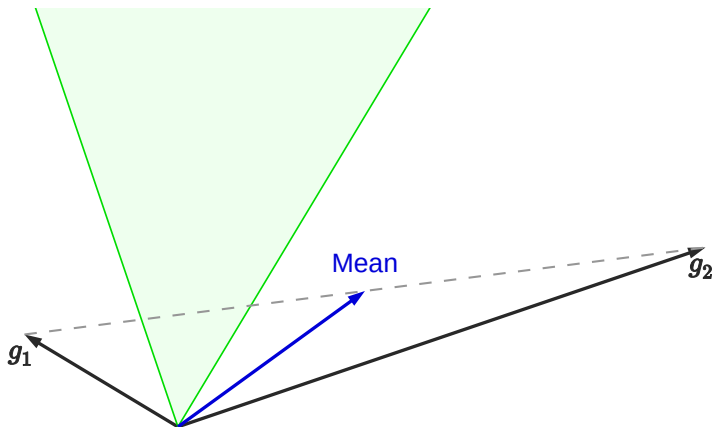
Unconflicting projection of gradients (UPGrad)



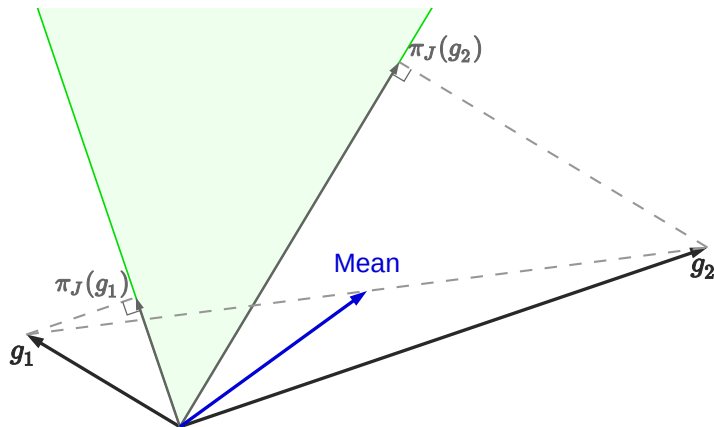
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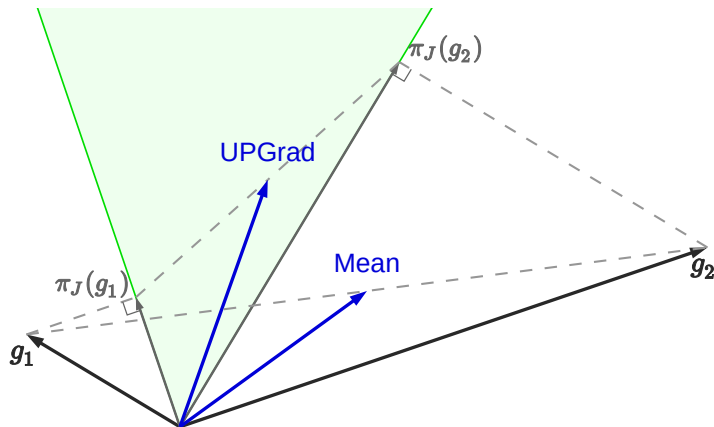
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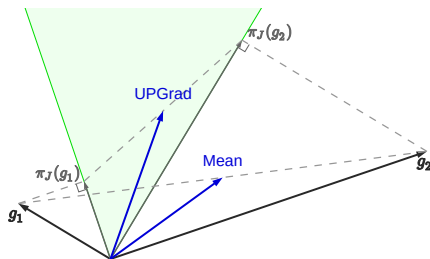
Formal definition of UPGrad

Given $J \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$, let C_J be the cone $\{\mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}^n : \mathbf{0} \preceq J\mathbf{y}\}$. $\mathcal{A}$ is non-conflicting if for all $J \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$, $\mathcal{A}(J) \in C_J$.

For any $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, the projection of $\mathbf{x}$ onto C_J is

$$\pi_J(\mathbf{x}) = \arg \min_{\mathbf{y} \in C_J} \|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{y}\|^2$$

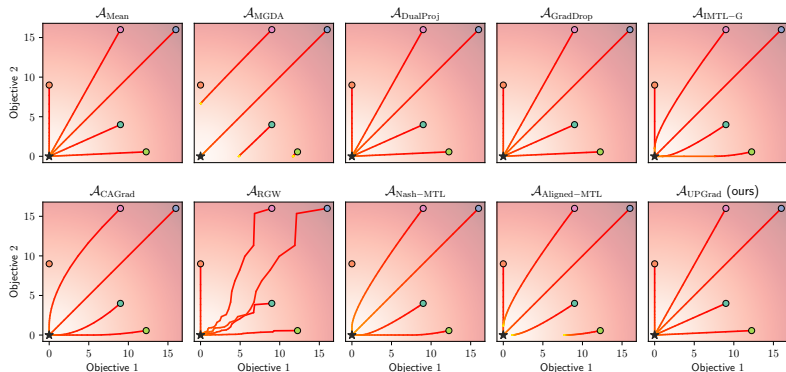
$$\mathcal{A}_{\text{UPGrad}}(J) = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i \in [m]} \pi_J(J^\top \mathbf{e}_i)$$



Applications and experimentation

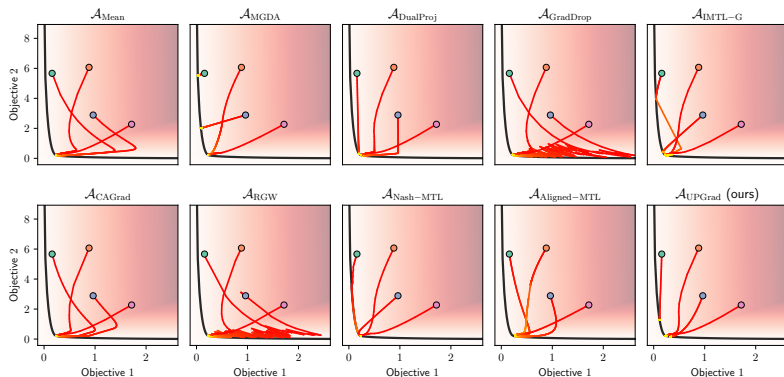
Synthetic example: element-wise quadratic function

Minimize $\mathbf{f} : \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} \mapsto \begin{bmatrix} x^2 \\ y^2 \end{bmatrix}$. It's Jacobian at $\begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix}$ is $\begin{bmatrix} 2x & 0 \\ 0 & 2y \end{bmatrix}$.

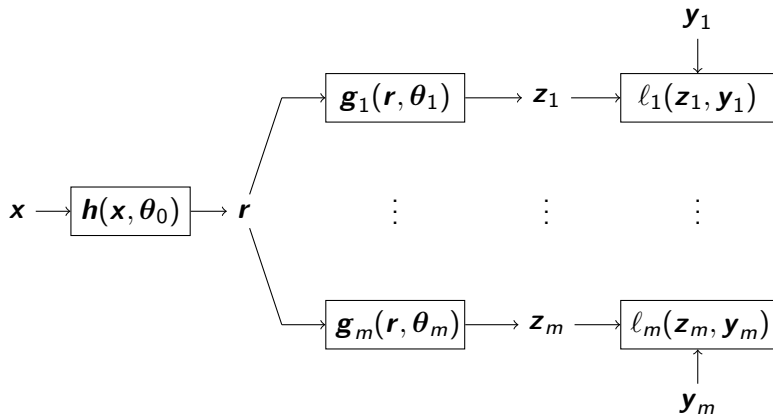


Synthetic example: convex quadratic form

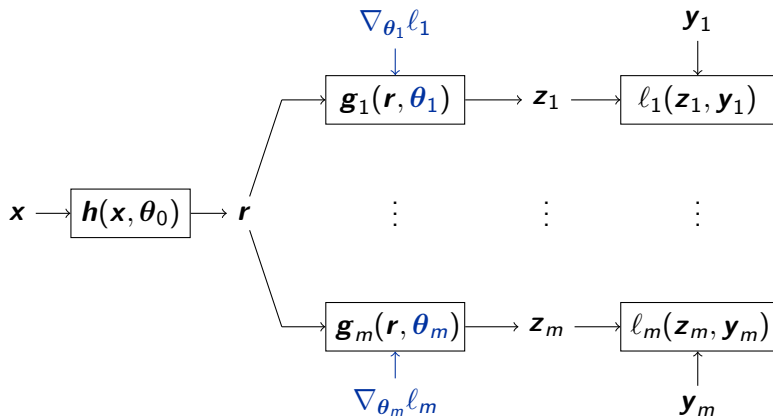
Some convex quadratic function $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$, with highly conflicting gradients.



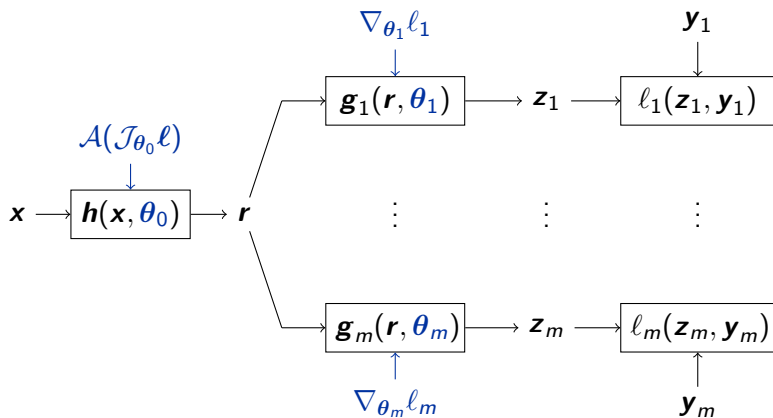
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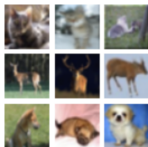
Experimental results: per-sample JD

Each element of the batch has its own loss.

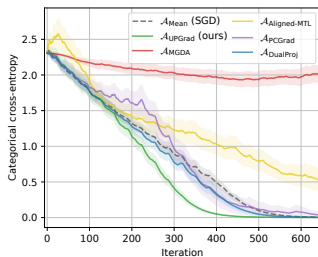
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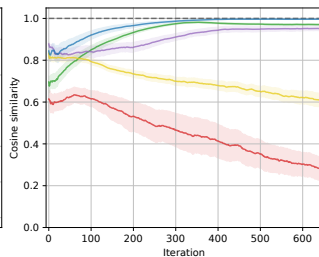
CIFAR-10



Training Loss



Update Similarity



Future directions

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- ▶ Could JD (per-sample) help training diffusion models?
- ▶ Could JD (per-depth) help training recurrent models?
- ▶ Find new applications.

My research interests

Finding new ways to train neural networks.

Finding new architectures (that are hard to train with SGD).

Making algorithms faster (e.g. new custom tensors, etc.).

Contributing to the open-source community.

Bonus: Gramian-based JD

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Applicable to most other aggregators from the literature.